

1. A newborn should pass meconium within what time after birth?

A. 6 hours

B. 12 hours

C. 24–48 hours

D. 72 hours

Answer: C. 24–48 hours

Rationale: Normal newborns pass first stool within 1–2 days. Delay may indicate obstruction.

2. Meconium is best described as:

- A. Yellow and watery
- B. Greenish-black, thick, sticky stool
- C. Brown and formed stool
- D. Bloody stool

Answer: B. Greenish-black, thick, sticky stool

Rationale: Meconium contains bile, mucus, amniotic fluid, epithelial cells, and lanugo.

3. Failure of a newborn to pass meconium within 48 hours may suggest:

- A. Normal finding
- B. Hirschsprung disease
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Sepsis only

Answer: B. Hirschsprung disease

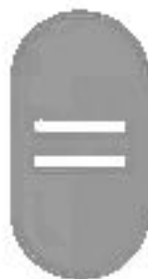
Rationale: Delayed meconium passage may indicate intestinal obstruction such as Hirschsprung or meconium ileus.

4. Meconium-stained amniotic fluid places the newborn at risk for:

- A. Hypoglycemia
- B. Meconium Aspiration Syndrome (MAS)
- C. Jaundice
- D. Anemia

Answer: B. Meconium Aspiration Syndrome (MAS)

Rationale: Inhalation of meconium can block airways and cause respiratory distress.



5. Which is an early sign of Meconium Aspiration Syndrome?

- A. Bradycardia
- B. Respiratory distress with grunting
- C. Hypothermia
- D. Projectile vomiting

Answer: B. Respiratory distress with grunting

Rationale: MAS causes airway obstruction → tachypnea, retractions, nasal flaring, cyanosis.



6. Priority nursing action for a non-vigorous newborn with meconium-stained fluid:

- A. Immediate feeding
- B. Dry and stimulate only
- C. Prepare for airway suction and resuscitation
- D. Keep baby warm only

Answer: C. Prepare for airway suction and resuscitation

Rationale: Airway must be cleared to prevent aspiration and improve breathing.



7. A newborn passes meconium before birth. What does this usually indicate?

- A. Prematurity
- B. Fetal distress or hypoxia
- C. Normal mature reflex
- D. Infection only

Answer: B. Fetal distress or hypoxia

Rationale: Hypoxia stimulates intestinal peristalsis and anal sphincter relaxation.

8. Meconium ileus is commonly associated with:

- A. Down syndrome
- B. Cystic fibrosis
- C. Spina bifida
- D. Congenital heart disease

Answer: B. Cystic fibrosis

Rationale: Thick, sticky meconium obstructs intestines in CF newborns.



9. Which assessment finding suggests intestinal obstruction in a newborn?

- A. Passing meconium at 12 hrs
- B. Abdominal distention and vomiting
- C. Soft abdomen and active bowel sounds
- D. Yellow stool day 2

Answer: B. Abdominal distention and vomiting

Rationale: Classic signs of bowel obstruction with delayed meconium.



10. Normal progression of newborn stool is:

A. Meconium → Transitional → Yellow stool

B. Yellow → Meconium → Transitional

C. Brown → Black → Yellow

D. Transitional → Meconium → Yellow

Answer: A. Meconium → Transitional → Yellow stool

Rationale: Stool becomes lighter and looser as feeding starts.

11. Which newborn is at highest risk for MAS?

- A. Preterm baby with clear fluid
- B. Term baby with meconium-stained fluid and poor cry
- C. Preterm baby crying vigorously
- D. Term baby with no meconium

Answer: B. Term baby with meconium-stained fluid and poor cry

Rationale: Non-vigorous newborn with MSAF has higher aspiration risk.

12. Key nursing monitoring for a baby with MAS includes:

- A. Urine output only
- B. Respiratory status and oxygenation
- C. Feeding pattern only
- D. Weight gain only

Answer: B. Respiratory status and oxygenation

Rationale: MAS primarily affects breathing and gas exchange.

13. Chest X-ray in MAS typically shows:

A. Clear lungs

B. Hyperinflation and patchy infiltrates

C. Fluid in abdomen

D. Bone deformity

Answer: B. Hyperinflation and patchy infiltrates

Rationale: Meconium blocks airways causing uneven ventilation.

14. Most appropriate initial management for mild MAS:

- A. Immediate surgery
- B. Oxygen therapy and observation
- C. Stop breathing support
- D. Give oral antibiotics only

Answer: B. Oxygen therapy and observation

Rationale: Mild cases improve with supportive respiratory care.